

Money

Although it's only made of cheap metals or paper, money makes it easier to **BUY** the things you need.



Loose change

Before money, people would swap or **BARTER** for the things they needed. Over time, useful or beautiful things, such as shells, feathers, and ***even dried tea***, were used instead of bartering. Around 650 BCE, the kingdom of Lydia (modern-day western Turkey) began to stamp gold and silver metal disks called staters (above). They were the **first coins**.

Taking notes

Paper money took shape in China by the 1100s, as a way of avoiding the weighty coinage necessary to ***complete large transactions***. Although news of printed money filtered into Europe, it was another 500 years before **SWEDEN** issued the continent's first banknotes in 1661.

How it changed

Money has transformed the world into a global economy made up of different currencies, giving almost everything a price.

the world

Cash to credit

These days, most people **spend their money** without using coins or banknotes at all. **DEBIT CARDS** enable you to access the money in your bank account at any time. Banks also issue ***credit cards***, allowing consumers to buy items immediately and pay back the debts over time.

The chip stores information about the account.

